

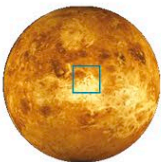


LINEAR RIDGES

Ridges 20–40 miles (30–60 km) long lie along a northern slope of Ovda Regio. Dark lava, or possibly windblown dirt, fills the spaces between the ridges.

APHRODITE TERRA

Ovda Regio



TYPE Highland terrain
AGE Under 500 million years
DIAMETER 3,279 miles (5,280 km)

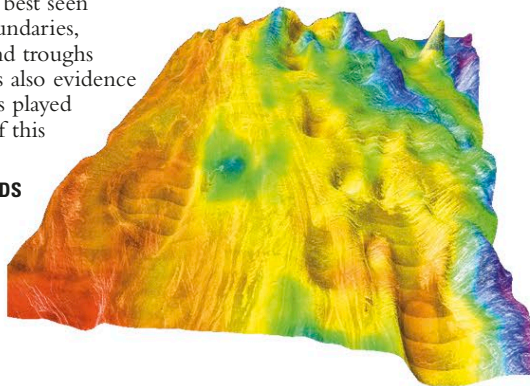
Ovda Regio is a highland area in Venus's equatorial region. It forms the western part of Aphrodite Terra, Venus's most extensive highland system, which rises 2 miles (3 km) above the mean surface level. Ovda Regio is one of a handful of highland regions on Venus that displays a type of complex ridge terrain known as tessera, a form of terrain, that was first identified in images taken by

Veneras 15 and 16. Tesserae are raised plateau-shaped regions with chaotic and complex patterns of crisscrossing lines. In places, the planet's crust has been fractured into mile-sized blocks. Elsewhere there are folds, faults, and belts of ridges and grooves hundreds of miles long. These are best seen along Ovda Regio's boundaries, where curving ridges and troughs have developed. There is also evidence that volcanic activity has played its part in the shaping of this

landscape. Magma, which may have welled up from the planet's interior, has flowed across part of the region, and ridges formed by compression have filled with lava. Ovda Regio is named after a Marijjan (Russian) forest goddess.

HIGHLANDS AND LOWLANDS

Tessera ridges run between the Ovda Regio highland (right) and lowland lava flows (left). Some of the highland depressions have been partially filled by smooth material.



APHRODITE TERRA

Miralaidji Corona



TYPE Corona
AGE Under 500 million years
DIAMETER 186 miles (300 km)

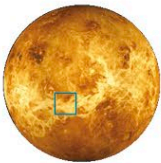
This large volcanic feature was formed by a plume of magma rising under the Venusian surface. The magma partially melted the crustal rock, which was raised up above the surrounding land to produce the corona, a blisterlike formation with radial faulting. The coronae on Venus range in size from about 30 to 1,600 miles (50 to 2,600 km) across and are circular to elongate in shape. They are named after fertility goddesses. Miralaidji is an Aboriginal fertility goddess.



RADIAL FAULTING

APHRODITE TERRA

Dali Chasma



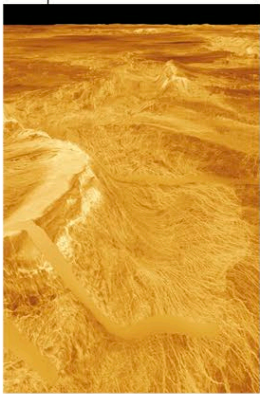
TYPE Fault
AGE Under 500 million years
LENGTH 1,291 miles (2,077 km)

The Dali Chasma lies in western Aphrodite Terra. It is a system of canyons and deep troughs coupled with high mountains that makes a broad, curving cut through more than 1,200 miles (2,000 km) of the planet's surface. Along with the Diana Chasma system, it connects the Ovda and Thetis highland regions with the large volcanoes at Atla Regio.

The mountain ranges associated with the canyons rise for 2–2.5 miles (3–4 km) above the surrounding terrain. The canyons are 1.2–2.5 miles (2–3 km) deep.

TROUGHS

In this view along the Dali Chasma, part of the raised rim of the 600-mile (1,000-km) wide Latona Corona is visible on the left.



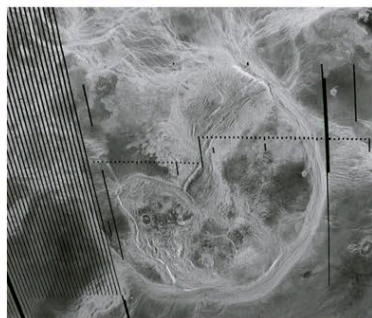
APHRODITE TERRA

Artemis Corona



TYPE Corona
AGE Under 500 million years
DIAMETER 1,614 miles (2,600 km)

Artemis is more than twice as big as the next largest corona on Venus, Heng-o. A nearly circular trough, Artemis Chasma, which has a raised rim, marks its boundary. Within it are complex systems of fractures, volcanic flows, and small volcanoes. Artemis, like other coronae, could have been formed by hot material welling up under the surface. But its large size and the surrounding trough mean that other forces, such as the pulling apart of the crust and surface, were involved.



ARTEMIS CORONA AND ARTEMIS CHASMA

LADA TERRA

Lada Terra



TYPE Highland terrain
AGE Under 500 million years
LENGTH 5,350 miles (8,615 km)

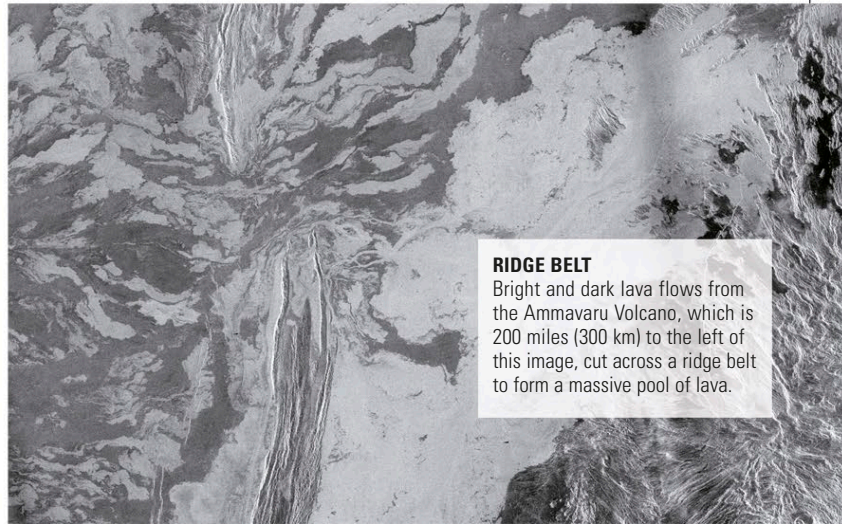
Lada is the second largest of three highland regions on Venus. It is in the south polar region of the planet, largely south of latitude 50°S, and comparatively little is known about it. Lada Terra includes some typical tessera terrain of crisscrossing troughs and ridges. Volcanic activity has also affected the area. Lada includes three large coronae (blisterlike features), called

LAVA CHANNEL

Part of a 745-mile (1,200-km) long channel, carved through Lada Terra by high-temperature, very fluid lava, runs from west to east across the center of this image.



Quetzalpetlatl, Eithinoha, and Otygen. Lava has flowed over and cut through the northern part of the region. All three terras on Venus are named after goddesses of love: Aphrodite is named after the Greek goddess; Ishtar (see p.120), the Babylonian goddess; and Lada, the Slavic goddess.



RIDGE BELT

Bright and dark lava flows from the Ammavaru Volcano, which is 200 miles (300 km) to the left of this image, cut across a ridge belt to form a massive pool of lava.